JEREMY LIGHTSMITH

For over 25 years, I've helped organizations navigate change, design better ways of working, and unlock the potential of their people. I work as a change management consultant, facilitator, and executive coach — bringing deep systems thinking and hands-on leadership experience.

My background in software gives me a practitioner's lens: I've led teams, founded companies, and transformed organizations from the inside and out. I'm as effective running large-group facilitation as I am in a one-on-one coaching conversation or working with senior leadership on structural change.

EXPERTISE

Change Management
Human Systems Dynamics
Facilitation
Executive Coaching
Open Space
Liberating Structures
Lean Transformation
Design Thinking
Systems Thinking
Mediation
Agile / Scrum

EDUCATION

University of Southern California
BS in Computer Science

Hudson Coaching Institute
Santa Barbara, CA
ICF Leadership Coaching
(graduation: Jan 2027)

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SELECTED ENGAGEMENTS

- **Lean transformation** — Led a value stream mapping intervention at Mechanical Orchard's flagship client that shifted management from accruing waste to owning continuous improvement; built a pull-based job wall as the day-to-day management system
- **Company offsite design & facilitation** — Designed and facilitated multiple week-long Open Space offsites for 60+ people at remote-first companies, creating the conditions for distributed teams to do their best face-to-face work
- **Innovation consulting** — Consulted with Nordstrom IT on removing structural obstacles to innovation; led workshops with buyers on borrowing practices from the innovation lab — retrospectives, Design Thinking, rapid prototyping
- **Project Inceptions + Chartering** — Facilitated dozens of multi-day inceptions across companies, shifting client organizations from command-and-control toward collaborative, adaptive delivery; setting the project teams up for success
- **Org design at scale** — Built Transparent Classroom as a self-managed, teal organization; 14 people, $3M ARR, consistently outperforming 100-person competitors through intentional culture and process design
- **Retreat facilitation** — Fifteen years of designing and facilitating personal transformation retreats

EXPERIENCE

Mechanical Orchard — 2023 - 2026

TEAM LEAD

Our client had no consistent way to see or measure their work — the wrong things were being prioritized, work was batching up, and delivery was slowing down. I taught enough lean thinking that management could own the problem themselves. The turning point was a value stream mapping session that made the waste visible and gave leadership a shared language for fixing it. I supplemented this with a custom "job wall" — a pull-based management system that became the daily heartbeat for how work flowed.

TalentWall — 2021 - 2023

LEAD DEVELOPER

Led the team through a full rewrite of their entire codebase while simultaneously hardening and performance-tuning the existing product to support business growth. Introduced team practices that kept a distributed team aligned and moving through a high-uncertainty transition.

Transparent Classroom — 2012 - 2021+

FOUNDER / CEO

Transparent Classroom was a decade-long process experiment. Starting from scratch, I deliberately evolved the company toward a self-managed, teal structure — using just-in-time planning and delivery, and continuous retrospection to shape how we worked. The result: a 14-person team generating $3M in annual revenue, consistently outperforming much larger competitors in a niche market. I continue to serve on the board.

Outpace Systems, Inc — 2014 - 2016

TEAM LEAD / DEVELOPER

In addition to leading a technical team, I introduced company-wide practices for managing work and set up effective remote-first meeting structures. I facilitated the bi-annual in-person conference, designing it to make the most of rare face-to-face time across a distributed organization.

Lightsmith Consulting LLC

2009 - 2013

I worked with and coached teams that wanted to be more lean and agile. Engagements ranged from afternoon trainings to multi-year embedded coaching and delivery in retail, telecommunications, insurance, and tech startups. Highlights include:

COACH / CONSULTANT *Client: Nordstrom Innovation Lab*

The lab was both a product team and an internal consulting resource. I helped the team develop their own innovation process, drawing on Lean Startup, Liberating Structures, and Design Thinking. The lab was regularly brought into the broader IT organization to consult on removing obstacles to innovation and faster delivery. I coached directors and senior leaders one-on-one through the challenges of leading change inside a large, complex organization. I also led workshops with buyer teams outside of IT, introducing practices like retrospectives and Design Thinking that could transfer beyond the lab.

AGILE COACH *Client: Vertafore, Insurance Company*

Coached scrum masters, introduced dev practices, and led workshops with their 40-person team through their third year of agile adoption.

Pivotal Labs

2007 - 2009

CLIENT PRINCIPAL / CONSULTANT

I introduced the practice of inceptions to start projects and set them up for success -- this became Pivotal's standard practice. As an anchor, I led teams and managed scope, client relationships, and team health.

ThoughtWorks Inc.

2000 - 2007

I served as coach, developer, and facilitator across many projects. Highlights include:

LEAD FACILITATOR / TRAINER, *QuickStart Engagements*

Designed and facilitated multi-day inceptions as culture-change interventions — shifting client teams and stakeholders from command-and-control toward collaborative ways of working. Trained other facilitators and ran these for projects ranging from small teams to multi-million dollar engagements.

AGILE COACH / SENIOR ARCHITECT *Client: Major Financial Company*

Helped a 30-person team adopt agile practices across 3 geographically distributed sites.

COMMUNITY & FACILITATION WORK

Human Systems Dynamics Institute

2018 - 2020

BOARD MEMBER

Served on the board of the institute that develops and teaches the Human Systems Dynamics framework — a complexity-based approach to adaptive action in organizations.

Agile Open Northwest

2015 - 2020

BOARD MEMBER / OPEN SPACE FACILITATOR

Helped govern and facilitate the annual Agile conference for the Pacific Northwest.

Chautauqua + Retreat of TBD

2012 - present

CO-FOUNDER / OPEN SPACE FACILITATOR

Co-founded and facilitate annual retreats that gather dancers, burners, and misfits for 3 days of intentional connection, personal growth, and play.

Lighthouse Montessori School

2008 - present

CO-FOUNDER / BOARD CHAIR

Co-founded the school; provide ongoing board leadership connecting the parent community with the school's organizational health and long-term direction.

Burn Blue

2007 - 2013

CO-FOUNDER / DIRECTOR

Started a weekly dance that at its height drew 150+ dancers each Tuesday. I designed the structure of the organization and facilitated quarterly community meetings.

References available upon request